legendary books. They have never been found. But Shiv Verma, who was in jail with Bhagat Singh, confirmed later as an editor of Bhagat Singh's selected writings that four books were written by the revolutionary. Chaman Lal, who has written most extensively about this matter, is circumspect, observing, 'It is not clear if Verma actually read or saw these manuscripts or simply heard Bhagat Singh saying that he is working on them.'[8] Nevertheless, what is undoubtedly maintained by Chaman Lal is that 'clearly Bhagat Singh did write something, and what he wrote was smuggled out of the jail by Kumari Lajjawati of Jalandhar'.[9] So the well-settled view appears to be that, after he toiled away to complete his writings, some of them were secretly whisked out of prison into the trusting hands of Kumari Lajjawati, who was after all the secretary of the Lahore Conspiracy Case Defence Committee as well as a renowned Congress activist. She had been visiting the Central Jail in Lahore frequently to ensure that the Lahore conspirators were given such legal assistance in their defence as was possible. She is even said to have tied a 'rakhee' (a talisman that celebrates brotherhood and love) on Bhagat Singh's wrist. The bundle of documents that had been handed over were shown by Lajjawati to the editor of *The People*, Lala Feroz Chand, this being the newspaper founded by Lala Lajpat Rai.

At any rate, this is what Lajjawati appears to have said when she was interviewed for the oral history archive of the Nehru Memorial Museum & Library.[10] The disclosure to Lala Feroz Chand of the bundle of documents enabled the publication of one of the writings of Bhagat Singh, namely, his celebrated, 'Why I Am an Atheist', on 27 September 1931. This was designed to coincide with what would have been Bhagat Singh's twenty-fourth birthday. Indeed, further extracts were also published and these included Bhagat Singh's 'Letter to Young Political Workers'. However, the bundle of documents has never been found. The reason for this is that Lajjawati herself passed them over to Bejoy Kumar Sinha in 1938, after he had served his sentence of transportation for life in the dreaded Andaman Islands following his trial with Bhagat Singh in the Lahore Conspiracy Case. He passed them over to another friend, who wasted little time in